

Team Project Paper

BUAD-304 | Organizational Behavior and Leadership

Instructor: Christine El Haddad

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	15%
Start date:	2026-08-31
Due date:	2026-11-09
Group project:	Yes

Course Schedule (due dates)

- Due: 2026-11-09 | refer? 9 -- 9 of 16 -- M Team Project Team project paper due (one 11/9 Presentations submission per team). Presentation slides are due on 11/9 before class. W Veteran's Day - No Class 11/11

Course Schedule (dated sessions)

- 2026-08-26 | 8/26 Attitudes & ARES Reading: Park, N. & Peterson, C. Character Strengths Ethics (2009) Character Strengths: Research and assessment in class. Practice Other: Watch the USC-CT and Case Analysis videos at this link. M Individual Textbook Re
- 2026-09-23 | 9/23 Exercise: 12 Angry Men M Communica- Textbook Reading: Ch. 9 & 10.1-10.4 Team project proposal & team
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Related Mentions

- M Team Project Team project paper due (one

- 11/9 Presentations submission per team).
- Presentation slides are due on
- 11/9 before class.
- W Veteran's Day - No Class
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- M Meta-4 Note: Class meets in the ELC
- 11/16 Exercise
- W Team Project Self and peer evaluation due
- 11/18 Presentations
- M In-class Video Assignment: Complete the video Before class, your team needs
- 11/23 Exercise: interviews of the Omega executives PRIOR to assign each team member to
- Omega to class using this link. interview several of the 9
- Systems Omega Systems executives.
- Have at least 2 people
- interview each executive so
- you do not miss any details.
- Make sure that everyone gets
- interviewed. Bring your
- interview notes to class to
- assist in the exercise.
- W Thanksgiving Break - No Class
- 11/25
- M Organizational Textbook Reading: Ch. 16
- 11/30 -tional ARES Reading: Cummings, T. (1995).
- Change From Programmed Change to Self-Design:
- Learning How to Change Organizations.
- Assessment(s):
- • Self-Assessment 16.02: What Is Your
- Readiness for Change?
- • Self-Assessment 16.03: Assessing Your
- Resistance to Change
- W Final Review Bring questions to ask your professor Personal Reflection Paper due
- 12/2 Question Course evaluations to be completed in class.
- Session
- Final Exam MW 4:00 - 5:50pm section:
- Wed., December 9; 4:30pm - 6:30pm

- MW 6:00 - 7:50pm section:
- Wed., December 9; 7pm - 9pm
- 10
- Additional Information
- USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative
- The USC Marshall Critical Thinking Initiative is a school-wide effort to improve your critical thinking skills in order to be more successful problem solvers in class and ultimately in the workplace. This means
- that you will engage in a variety of learning activities in your courses which are aimed at developing and
- applying your critical thinking skills in a disciplined manner so that you can outperform others to get your
- desired job and to further excel in your career. Your ability to think critically is an important part of the
- evaluation/grading process in this course. The centerpiece of Marshall's critical thinking knowledge is a
- website that contains instructional materials and videos. We utilize these resources to prepare you to do the
- case analysis assignments. Here is the link to the website.
- Academic Integrity
- The University of Southern California is foremost a learning community committed to fostering successful
- scholars and researchers dedicated to the pursuit of knowledge and the transmission of ideas. Academic
- misconduct is contrary to this fundamental mission and includes any act of dishonesty in the submission of
- academic work (either in draft or final form), as well as cheating, plagiarism, fabrication (e.g., falsifying
- data), knowingly assisting others in acts of academic dishonesty, and any act that gains or is intended to
- gain an unfair academic advantage. Students are expected to uphold the highest standards of academic
- integrity in all coursework. This course follows the expectations for academic integrity as stated in the USC
- Student Handbook. All students are expected to submit assignments that are original work and prepared
- specifically for the course/section in this academic term. Students may not submit work written by others
- or "recycle" work prepared for other courses without obtaining written permission from the instructor(s).
- Students suspected of academic misconduct will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

- Academic dishonesty has a far-reaching impact and is considered a serious offense against the university.
- Violations will result in a grade penalty, such as a failing grade on the assignment or in the course, and
- disciplinary action from the university, such as suspension or expulsion. For more information about
- academic integrity see the Student Handbook, the Office of Academic Integrity's website, and university
- policies on Research and Scholarship Misconduct. Please ask your instructor if you are unsure what
- constitutes unauthorized assistance on an exam or assignment or what information requires citation and/or
- attribution.
- Instructors determine whether and how generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude, Gemini,
- and similar applications) and other external resources (such as English-language translation tools) may be
- used in this course. Expectations may vary from assignment to assignment. This includes AI tools that
- record, transcribe, or summarize class sessions, which may require express instructor permission. Review
- the AI use guidance provided carefully, and direct any questions to your instructor before submitting work.
- Students seeking general guidance may consult the following resources:
- • USC Student Handbook
- • Generative AI General Policy
- • Practical Tips for Using AI in Academic Work
- • Office of Academic Integrity
- Statement Around Use of AI Tools
- Since creating, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all
- assignments should be prepared by the student working individually or in groups. Students may not have
- another person or entity complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Developing strong
- competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Additionally, adding copyrighted
- case content to an LLM such as ChatGPT is a violation of our case publisher Harvard University's terms
- of use and copyright. Therefore, using AI tools is prohibited in this course, will be identified as plagiarism,
- and will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.
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- Add/Drop Process

- Most Marshall classes are open enrollment (R-clearance) through the Add deadline. If there is an open seat,
- you can add the class using Web Registration. If the class is full, you will need to continue checking Web
- Registration or the Schedule of Classes to see if a space becomes available. Students who do not attend the
- first two class sessions (for classes that meet twice per week) or the first class meeting (for classes that meet
- once per week) may be dropped from the course. Therefore, let me know if you have any conflicts in Week
- 1 like visa or health issues so you aren't dropped. There are no formal wait lists for Marshall undergraduate
- courses, and professors cannot add students or increase the course capacity. If all sections of the course are
- full, you can add your name to an interest list by contacting the Office of Undergraduate Advising & Student
- Affairs; if new seats or sections are added, students on the interest list will be notified.
- Statement on Technology Use
- I expect you to be responsible in using technology in class. You will need to "be here and be present" so
- that we can create an engaging learning community. It is far more important to participate in class than to
- take detailed notes. Course powerpoint slides and class recordings will be posted to Brightspace. After
- each class session, you may want to take some time to reflect on the learning experience and type up
- whatever notes seem useful.
- Videotaping faculty lectures is not permitted due to copyright infringement regulations. Audiotaping may
- be permitted if approved by the professor. Use of any recorded or distributed material is reserved
- exclusively for the USC students registered in this class. Exceptions to this policy may be granted to
- individual students with appropriate documentation on a case-by-case basis.
- Use of Recordings
- Pursuant to the USC Student Handbook (<https://policy.usc.edu/studenthandbook/>, pages 16 and 59),
- distribution or use of notes, recordings, exams, or other intellectual property, based on university
- classes or
- lectures without the express permission of the instructor for purposes other than individual or group
- study
- is prohibited. This includes but is not limited to providing materials for distribution by services
- publishing
- course materials. This restriction on unauthorized use also applies to any information, created by
- another,

- distributed to students, or in any way had been displayed for use in relationship to the class, whether
- obtained in class, via email, on the internet, or via any other method. Distributing course material without
- the instructor's permission will be presumed to be an intentional act to facilitate or enable academic
- dishonesty and is strictly prohibited. Violations of this policy may subject an individual or entity to
- Team Project
- You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The
- goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide
- you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze
- an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical
- interpersonal and teamwork skills.
- Your team will have a choice of conducting either:
- 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or
- other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that
- connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure
- and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make
- recommendations based on your study.
- 4
- 2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple
- organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or
- something in your own experience. You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in
- detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best
- practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research).
- Your "deliverable" for this project has five components:
- 1. Project proposal with team contract
- 2. Detailed outline of paper
- 3. Project paper
- 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A
- 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class).
- Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch margins
- on all sides.

- Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team.
- As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective
- feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer
- evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace.
- The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the
- presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the
- analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of
- conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The
- detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper.
- Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace.
- Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on
- my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful
- consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.
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Full Syllabus Extract

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